

Carlos Ruiz

carlosruiz1@live.com | www.linkedin.com/in/cruizdev | clos2024.github.io

Professional Experience

Zenimax Online Studios | Systems Designer | Jun 2022 – Present

Elder Scrolls Online (PC/Xbox/PlayStation/Stadia)

General

- Worked across multiple gameplay departments to polish and ship 4 major title updates per year.
- Assisted in implementing/balancing itemization efforts for dungeons, delves, trials, and overworld drops.
- Maintained standards for new play area systems such as lootable interactables and resource nodes.
- Created documentation uniquely tailored for stakeholder review, QA test plan creation, and cross department knowledge sharing.
- Mentored Interns and trained new hires on development pipelines, tools, and studio best practices.

Feature Lead

- Worked with the data science team to create a reboarding experience known as “Heros Return” which targeted lapsed players and lead to an increase in re-acquisition/retention.
- Organized cross-department playtests to facilitate and implement feedback on designs.
- Designed and implemented long-requested player QOL features such as multi-filleting, improved furnishing crafting material gathering, and accurate furnishing alignments.

Housing Feature Team

- Responsible for designing and shipping 8–10 unique house level offerings per year.
- Analyzed player feedback and market data to create premium in-game housing store offerings.
- Rapidly prototyped, pitched, and shipped new interactable house features to stakeholders.
- Assisted in implementing 50–200 unique furnishing items per title update.

DePaul Originals Game Studio | Gameplay Design Intern | Jan 2022 – Apr 2022

Killectibles (PC/Mobile) -- Turn-based strategy game developed in Unreal Engine.

- Worked closely with engineers to create multiplayer territorial combat game modes.
- Designed turn based combat and movement rules of play.
- Created development pipelines for artists to get their work into functioning assets in engine.

Personal Projects

Run N’ Gun (PC) 2022 | Lead Gameplay Programmer / Designer | Engine: Unity

Arcade Shooter developed by a 5 person team in 18 weeks for a university capstone project.

https://store.steampowered.com/app/1945060/Run_N_Gun/

- Designed and implemented a rollerblading physics-based movement system.
- Created 3 enemy archetypes each with their own unique pathfinding and combat abilities.
- Created 5 weapons and 3 power ups with unique gameplay augmenting features.
- Created a “Quip” system where the enemies of the game would contextually insult the player based of in game events.
- Created in engine tools for designers to rapidly iterate on weapon, enemy, and power up behavior.

Education

DePaul University | Bachelor of Science in Game Design | Jun. 2018 – Mar. 2022

GPA: 3.9/4.0 | Honors: Summa Cum Laude

Skills

Engines: Unity, Unreal Engine, GameMaker Studio

Programming: C#, Python, HTML/CSS, UE5 Blueprints

Misc: Jira, Confluence, Perforce, Git, MS Office Suite, Google Docs Suite